

ISIPATHANA

INTERNATIONAL MEDITATION CENTER

(IIMC)

Draft Proposal

2025



WHERE WISDOM ENDS, AWAKENING BEGINS

Let us rise beyond all limits

From Stress to Stillness: Our Beginning

How Our Journey Began?

- In today's fast-moving world, moments of true calm have become rare treasures.
- We have seen friends, family, and colleagues struggling with stress, anxiety, and a constant sense of being "on."
- This inspired us to imagine a space where the noise of life fades away, a place designed entirely for peace, presence, and personal growth.

Why This Matters Now?

- Stress and burnout are rising across all age groups.
- Mental health conversations are growing, but support spaces remain limited.
- Mindfulness and meditation are increasingly recognized as essential daily practices, not luxuries.

What is on our mind?

A welcoming, peaceful center where people of all ages can:

- Learn and deepen meditation skills.
- Practice mindfulness in a supportive community.
- Access tools for stress relief and emotional balance.

Here, the door will always be open to anyone seeking a moment of stillness.



The Story Behind the Vision & Mission

Vísión

Where wisdom ends, awakening begins...

Let us rise beyond all limits

Vision is not just about teaching meditation; it is about creating a living space for transformation. We believe that true growth occurs when knowledge is transformed into experience, and when the mind learns to be still enough for the heart to be heard. To be a sanctuary where every person can step beyond the boundaries of stress, fear, and limitation, and awaken to a life of clarity, compassion, and purpose.

Misión

- To offer spaces and practical techniques that nurture inner peace, mindful living, and spiritual growth.
- To welcome all regardless of age, background, or belief into a community built on kindness and respect.
- To inspire people to integrate mindfulness into daily life, so peace is not an escape, but a way of being.

Here, every breath is a step towards awakening, and every person's journey is honored as unique and sacred.



Our Logo



- Lotus Flower Symbol

The lotus represents purity, enlightenment, and spiritual awakening in Buddhist tradition. Just as the lotus rises from muddy water to bloom beautifully, it symbolizes the journey from ignorance and suffering to wisdom and peace. It reflects the purpose of our meditation center, which is to help individuals rise above challenges and reach a state of inner calm.

- Central Figure / Abstract Human Shape

This stylized figure at the heart of the lotus represents a meditating person, a symbol of mindfulness, inner focus, and spiritual practice. It reflects the rising of Sages, showing where such awakened individuals arise: in a space dedicated to wisdom, compassion, and the cultivation of inner peace.

- Blue Color Scheme

Blue symbolizes peace, serenity, trust, and wisdom. In Buddhist art, it is often associated with calmness and the vast, limitless nature of the mind.



Why the World Needs This Space?

In an age where technology connects us instantly yet leaves many feelings more disconnected than ever, the search for meaning, peace, and purpose has never been more urgent. Across the globe, people are turning to ancient wisdom for modern healing.

Buddhism, now one of the fastest-growing spiritual paths in the world, offers more than a religion; it is a way of understanding life and the mind.

The teachings of the Buddha guide us toward compassion, mindfulness, and liberation from suffering.

Yet, for many, the true essence of these teachings remains hidden beneath cultural layers and misconceptions. This center aims to create a space where people can:

- Understand the authentic principles of mindfulness and meditation taught by the Buddha.
- Experience these practices in a non-dogmatic, accessible way.
- Integrate timeless wisdom into the challenges of daily life.

We are not here to convert, but to connect to offer a place where anyone, regardless of belief, can discover the inner stillness that has guided seekers for over 2,500 years.



Leadership & Guidance

Our Coordinator

Rev. Sudhamma Nahangoda Thero

Special Representative of the Estonian Theravāda Sangha in Sri Lanka

- Bachelor of Arts (Honors) Second Class Upper Division Buddhist Philosophy Department of Pali and Buddhist Studies University of Ruhuna, Sri Lanka
- Pracheena Golden Pandit Intermediate Degree the Oriental Studies Society of Sri Lanka, Ministry of Education Sri Lanka.
- Master of Arts in Buddhist Studies Nāgānanda International Institute for Buddhist Studies, Department of Pali and Buddhist Studies, Sri Lanka
- Pāli Editor Estonian Theravada Sangha Tipitaka Translating Committee, Estonia
- Pāli and Buddhist Psychology Teacher Dhammavinaya Instituut, Estonia

Rev. Sudhamma Nahangoda Thero is a respected monk and scholar within the Theravāda Buddhist tradition, serving as the Special Representative of the Estonian Theravāda Sangha in Sri Lanka. His work bridges cultures and continents, promoting understanding and cooperation between Buddhist communities in Europe and Asia.

Well-versed in the Dhamma and deeply committed to spreading its benefits, he has engaged in a wide range of activities from in-depth analysis of Buddhist teachings to translating sacred texts and facilitating cross-cultural dialogues.

His ability to interpret and convey complex concepts in clear, practical terms has made him a valued guide for both practitioners and learners. With his guidance, the Meditation Center will be rooted in authenticity, clarity, and a profound respect for the true essence of the Buddha's teachings.

Rev. Sudhamma Nahangoda Thero

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What We Will Do at the Center

Programs & Services: Our center offers a range of programs tailored to meet the needs of individuals, families, organizations, and visitors from around the world.

Target Audience: Monastics, Employers, Tourists, Teenagers, and Children, Cultural Study Groups

- **Daily Guided Meditation:** Including breathing techniques and mindfulness practices for relaxation and focus.
- **Specialized Classes**
 - Buddhist Psychology
 - Buddhist Therapy
 - Buddhist Therapeutic Rituals
- **Stress Management & Mindfulness Workshops:** Practical tools to reduce anxiety and improve emotional balance.
- **Corporate Wellness Packages:** Mobile services designed for government institutions and private sector workplaces.
- **Mindfulness for Children & Teens:** Age-appropriate practices to develop focus, kindness, and resilience.
- **Programs for Foreigners:** Meditation and mindfulness combined with cultural immersion experiences.
- **Monthly “Mindfulness Circles.”**
- **Free meditation days for the public.**

Each program is designed to guide participants from the busyness of life into a place of stillness, clarity, and compassion.



Our Awakening Planning Templates

Sessions

1) Little Minds, Big Wisdom

(Child Personality Development through Mindfulness)

2) Mindful Moments in the Island of Serenity

(Meditation & Cultural Immersion for Foreign Visitors)

3) Calm Minds, Strong Workplaces

(Mindfulness for a Better Workforce)



Session 01

“Deepening the Path”

Mindfulness and Dhamma Enrichment for Monastics

In the life of a monastic, the path of mindfulness and Dhamma is one of continuous learning and deepening practice. This session offers a dedicated space for monks and nuns to step away from daily responsibilities and fully immerse themselves in meditation, reflection, and the study of the Buddha’s teachings.

Through guided practice, sutta study, and Dhamma sharing, participants will strengthen both inner calm and wisdom, fostering a renewed commitment to the spiritual path. It is a time to connect with fellow monastics, exchange knowledge, and return to the essence of the Buddha’s way with a fresh and peaceful mind.



- ✓ **Session No:**01
- ✓ **Session Title:** *Deepening the Path: Mindfulness and Dhamma Enrichment for Monastics*
- ✓ **Target Audience:** Resident and visiting Buddhist monks and nuns from Sri Lanka and abroad.
- ✓ **Duration:** Full-day
- ✓ **Venue:** Main meditation hall, temple garden,
- ✓ **Purpose & Objectives**
 - Provide a supportive space for monastics to deepen their meditation practice.
 - Facilitate Dhamma sharing and advanced study in both Theravāda and cross-traditional perspectives.
 - Offer periods of noble silence to encourage inner reflection.
 - Build a network for monastic cooperation locally and internationally.
- ✓ **Materials & Resources**
 - Meditation cushions and mats.
 - Dhamma books (Pali Canon, Commentaries, translations).
 - Audio-visual equipment for recorded talks.
 - Chanting books in Pali & English.
 - Simple vegetarian/vegan meals.
- ✓ **Methods & Approach**
 - Silent meditation periods (sitting, walking, standing).
 - Dhamma sharing circles for peer learning.
 - Sutta study with commentary discussions.
 - Chanting practice (morning and evening puja).
 - Personal practice time for deep reflection.
- ✓ **Session Flow / Activities**

Step	Description	Time
1	Morning Chanting & Meditation	5 min
2	Walking Meditation in Temple Garden	10 min
3	Dhamma Talk (Advanced Topic)	10 min
4	Group Meditation	15 min
5	Sutta Study & Discussion	15 min
6	Chanting Practice	5 min



Session 02

“Little Minds, Big Wisdom”

Child Personality Development through Mindfulness

In a world where children are often swept into the fast currents of change, stress, and competition, it is essential to give them the tools to grow with strength, balance, and kindness. This session is designed to nurture young hearts and minds, helping them rebuild self-confidence, strengthen self-esteem, and trust in their abilities. Through the timeless wisdom of the Buddha's teachings, children will learn how to face life's challenges with courage, maintain harmony within themselves, and walk their educational journey with clarity and purpose. Our aim is to raise mindful, compassionate, and resilient individuals who can stand firmly in society while carrying a peaceful mind and an open heart.



- ✓ **Session No:**02
- ✓ **Session Title:** *Child Personality Development through Mindfulness*
- ✓ **Target Audience:** Children
- ✓ **Duration:** 60 minutes per session
- ✓ **Venue:** Open, child-friendly space with cushions in a circle, Low tables for creative work.
- ✓ **Purpose & Objectives**
 - Cultivate self-confidence, emotional awareness, and kindness in children.
 - Improve focus, listening skills, and self-control through mindfulness-based activities.
 - Encourage values such as empathy, gratitude, and cooperation.
- ✓ **Materials & Resources**
 - Storybooks with moral lessons.
 - Drawing paper, crayons, markers.
 - Cushions or mats for sitting.
 - Soft background music for mindfulness practice.
- ✓ **Methods & Approach**
 - Play-based learning combined with mindfulness practices.
 - Simple meditation techniques adapted for children.
 - Group discussions and hands-on activities.
- ✓ **Session Flow / Activities**

Step	Description	Time
1	Welcome & Icebreaker (fun mindful activity)	5 min
2	Story Time with Moral Lesson	10 min
3	Guided Mindfulness Breathing	10 min
4	Interactive Activity (teamwork / kindness roleplay)	15 min
5	Creativity Session (drawing / journaling feelings)	15 min
6	Reflection & Gratitude Circle	5 min



Session 03

“Mindful Moments in the Island of Serenity”

Meditation & Cultural Immersion for Foreign Visitors

Through this program, we hope to give something new and meaningful to Sri Lanka's tourism industry. Visitors will not only see the beauty of our country but also feel it through meditation and mindfulness. We want them to have a relaxing and peaceful time here, learning about our culture while finding calm within themselves. This will be a memorable experience they can carry in their hearts long after they leave Sri Lanka.

✓ Session No:03



- ✓ **Session Title:** *Mindful Moments in the Island of Serenity*
- ✓ **Target Audience:** International and local tourists interested in wellness, spirituality, and culture.
- ✓ **Duration:** Day packages
- ✓ **Venue:** Meditation hall, Outdoor places
- ✓ **Purpose & Objectives**
 - Introduce tourists to authentic Sri Lankan meditation and mindfulness practices.
 - Share the cultural and historical significance of Buddhist traditions.
 - Provide a relaxing, meaningful, and educational experience.
- ✓ **Materials & Resources**
 - Meditation mats and cushions.
 - Printed handouts on Buddhist teachings & symbols.
 - Ritual items
 - Audio system for talks.
- ✓ **Methods & Approach**
 - Combination of practice (meditation), learning (culture, history), and participation (rituals, activities).
 - Hands-on experiences to make the session memorable.
- ✓ **Follow-up / Memory**
 - Give participants a small blessed souvenir
 - Email follow-up with guided meditation audio and further reading links.
- ✓ **Session Flow / Activities**

Step	Description	Time
1	Welcome Tea & Introduction to the Center	15 min
2	Guided Mindfulness Meditation	30 min
3	Walking Meditation in the Temple Garden	20 min
4	Dhamma Talk – Buddhism & Mindfulness in Daily Life	30 min
5	Cultural Activity (e.g., chanting session, lotus offering, incense ritual)	30 min
6	Sri Lankan Vegetarian Lunch or Tea Break	45 min
7	Cultural Studies Segment – Buddhist Art, Symbols, and History	45 min
8	Closing Circle & Souvenir Blessing	15 min



Session 04

“Calm Minds, Strong Workplaces”

Mindfulness for a Better Workforce

Through this program, we aim to bring a fresh and meaningful contribution to Sri Lanka's workforce. In today's busy working environments, stress and pressure can affect both performance and well-being. By introducing practical mindfulness and meditation techniques, we hope to help employees in government and private sectors cultivate calmness, clarity, and focus, creating healthier minds and more productive workplaces.



- ✓ **Session No:**04
- ✓ **Session Title:** *Calm Minds, Strong Workplaces*
- ✓ **Target Audience:** Employees from the government and private sectors
- ✓ **Duration:** one hour
- ✓ **Venue:** In the relevant institution
- ✓ **Purpose & Objectives**
 - Reduce workplace stress through mindfulness techniques
 - Improve focus, productivity, and emotional balance
 - Promote healthier and more harmonious work environments
- ✓ **Materials & Resources**
 - Meditation mats or chairs
 - Projector & screen for presentations
 - Audio system for guided meditations
 - Printed handouts with mindfulness exercises
- ✓ **Methods & Approach**
 - Practical, On-the-Spot Techniques
 - Guided Practice Sessions
- ✓ **Session Flow / Activities**

Step	Description	Time
1	Welcome Tea & Introduction to the Center	15 min
2	Guided Mindfulness Meditation	30 min
3	Walking Meditation in the Temple Garden	20 min
4	Dhamma Talk – Buddhism & Mindfulness in Daily Life	30 min
5	Cultural Activity (e.g., chanting session, lotus offering, or incense ritual)	30 min
6	Sri Lankan Vegetarian Lunch or Tea Break	45 min
7	Cultural Studies Segment – Buddhist Art, Symbols, and History	45 min
8	Closing Circle & Souvenir Blessing	15 min



Our Future Hopes

- We plan to create a unique space where people can experience monastic life for a set period. This opportunity will allow participants to live simply, follow a disciplined routine, and practice meditation as monks do.
- Around the world, this kind of program is known to bring deep personal insight and peace, yet it is still rare in Sri Lanka.
- Through this initiative, people will have the chance to truly step into the lifestyle, values, and mindfulness of a monastic way of living.



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